Summer 2026: Attention Bid - Test Harness

Here comes the test harness for the test assignment along with two+ rather stupid bots that would happily bid on anything.
The package is called *harness.zip* and it should be extracted in a directory.

What's in the package:

- An executable .jar that scans its working directory for bots and runs a simulated auction with all of them. Run the harness via **`java -jar harness.jar`**
- The minimal requirement to run the harness is Java 8.
- The test harness has altered weights for generation of the videos and viewers, along with different weights for the value calculation with regards to chosen advertisement category. Please keep in mind - *that's not the **'real'** harness* that would be used but it's close.
- The test harness auction completes by printing the final chart and some statistics of the participants
- A web server and a dashboard to visualize the process. The webserver starts on port 2026 by default. Appendix B there is an exhibit of a screenshot of the dashboard. It can be accessed via http://localhost:2026
- Two bots that are placed in subdirectories: `dumb0, dumb-retro`
- There is a bonus bot created by ChatGPT: `silly-gpt`

Running your own bot(s)

- Extract the contents of the archive in an empty directory. The directory will be known as *working directory.* Appendix C: shows the contents of the archive.
- Create a subdirectory under the working directory. The name of the bot would be the name of that subdirectory.
- Place an executable .jar in that directory
- Run the harness (as described above), make sure the harness is run from the working directory.

It's possible to place multiple bots in multiple subdirectories. The provided "dumb bots" use the directory where they are located as a base for the seed of their random generator. Feel free to multiply them, the harness will run all of them.

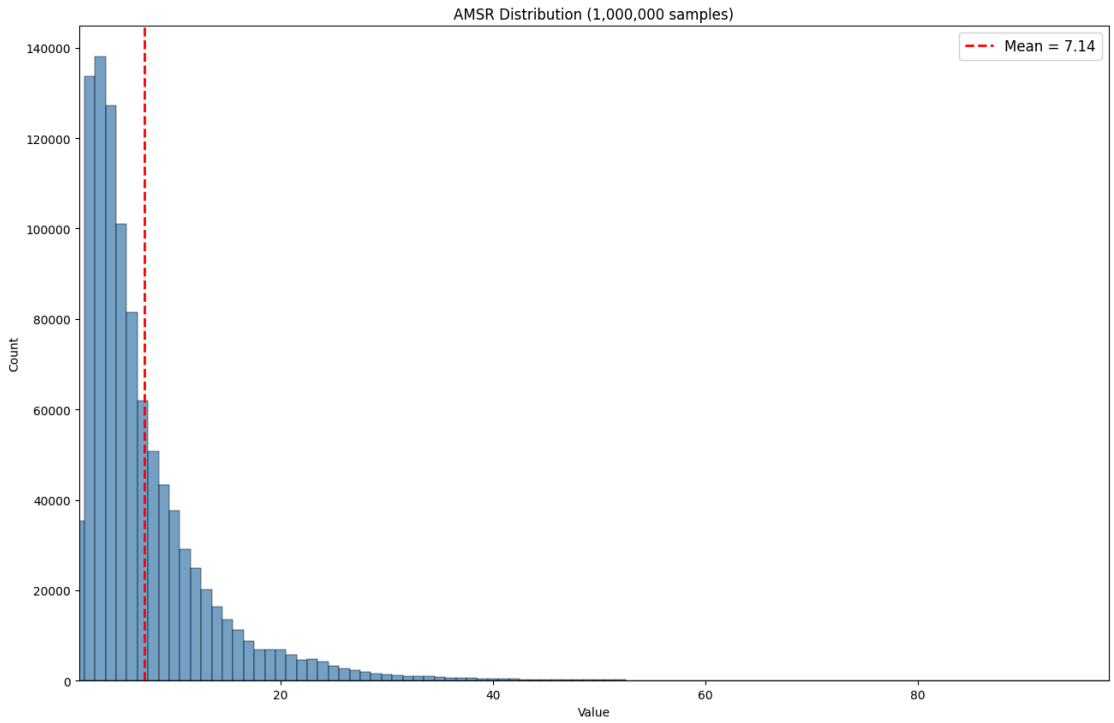
The directories where the bots are located will contain a file named: `err.log`
The file will be the redirected stderr (that should be used for logging purposes) of each bot.

As an extra - we generated the distribution of the calculated values for two categories with a million of samples. The distributions are “long tail” ones, closely fitting “negative binomial distribution”, or the famous 80-20 Pareto.

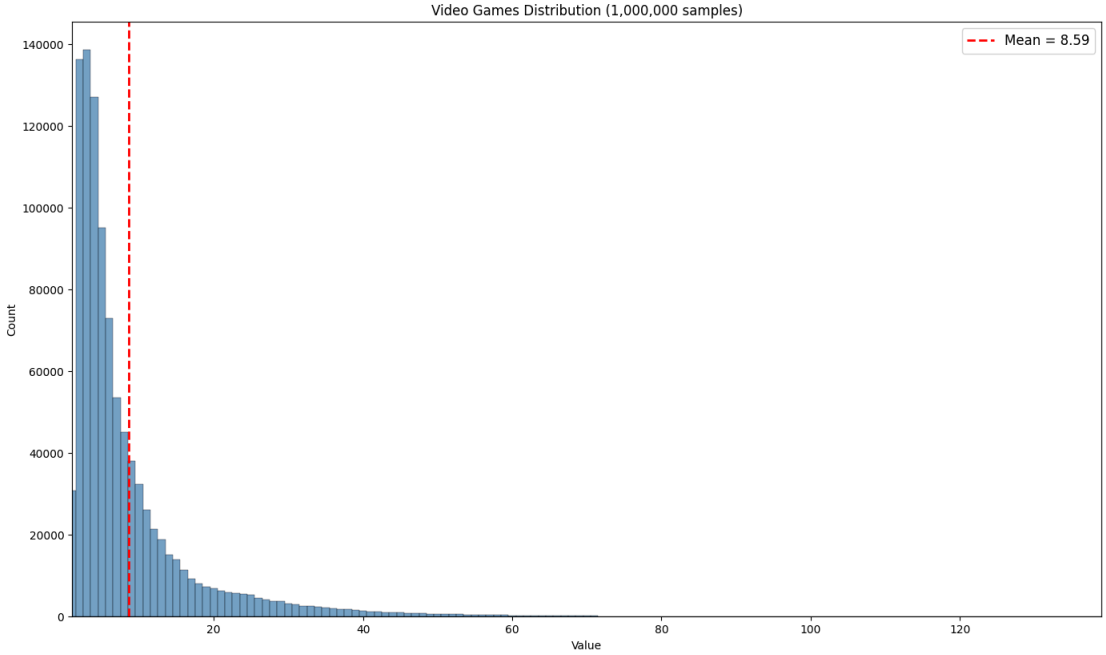
Appendix A: value distribution

Examples of value distribution based on 1 million samples:

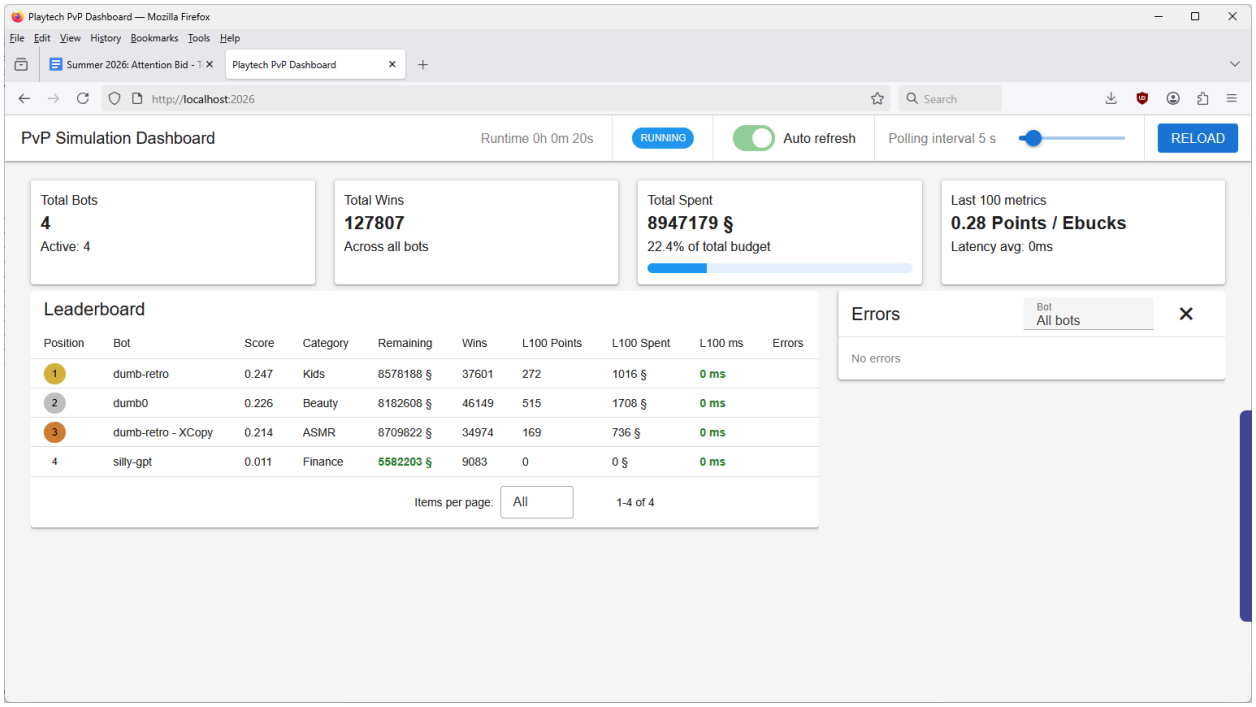
- ASMR category



- Video Games category



Appendix B: Dashboard screenshot



Appendix C: list of the files in the archive

```
$ ls -gG
total 204
drwxrwxrwx 1   4096 Mar 25 16:21 dumb-retro
drwxrwxrwx 1   4096 Mar 25 16:21 dumb0
-rwxrwxrwx 1 207284 Mar 25 16:19 harness.jar
drwxrwxrwx 1   4096 Mar 25 16:22 silly-gpt
```